INFORMATION SHEET

Evaluating the Efficacy of Sub-National Informational Comparisons
Principal Investigator: Adam D Roberts
Advisor: Scott Abramson

This form describes a research study that is being conducted by Adam Roberts (Advisor: Scott Abramson) from the University of Rochester's Department of Political Science. The purpose of this study is to learn more about how voters interpret information about politicians.

If you decide to take part in this study, you will be asked to complete 2 surveys (1 now, and 1 approximately 5 days later) that will take about 5 minutes each to complete. After participating in the first survey, you will be re-contacted by the survey provider to participate in the second survey. The surveys will ask questions about voting behavior, crime, political attitudes, and your home municipality. The second survey will also present you with information about either crime rates in your municipality or information about agave cultivation in Mexico. The specific information you receive will be randomly assigned. Both surveys include attention check questions to ensure data quality; if you fail an attention check, you will be excluded from the study and will not receive compensation. We estimate that approximately 2,200 people will take part in this study.

Some of the survey questions may be upsetting or make you feel uncomfortable, but participation carries no greater risk than reading the news. You may withdraw at any time and for any reason, but skipping questions is not permitted. This study will not collect any direct identifiers, like your name or government ID number. However, we will collect some indirect identifiers, namely the municipality in which you live, political affiliation, and demographic information. All information we collect will be stored in a secure manner and only study team members will have access to it. There are no other expected risks. There are also no expected benefits.

In exchange for your participation, Netquest will reward you with Korus (Points) that can be redeemed for rewards. The number of Korus (Points) you will earn in exchange for these activities will vary based on various factors set by Netquest. There will be no cost for you to participate in this study.

The University of Rochester makes every effort to keep the information collected from you private. To do so, your survey responses are stored in a secure, private cloud database accessible only to the researcher. All data are transmitted using encrypted connections, and your responses are saved under a randomly generated identifier with no connection to your name or contact information. The survey company retains your

personal contact details solely for the purpose of re-contacting you for the second wave of the study; these details are never shared with or stored by the research team at the University of Rochester.

Your participation in this study is completely voluntary. You are free not to participate or to withdraw at any time, for whatever reason. No matter what decision you make, there will be no penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled.

For more information or questions about this research you may contact Adam Roberts at arober48@ur.rochester.edu. Please contact the University of Rochester Research Subjects Review Board at 265 Crittenden Blvd., CU 420628, Rochester, NY 14642, Telephone +1 (585) 273-4127 or +1 (877) 449-4441 for the following reasons:

- You wish to talk to someone other than the research staff about your rights as a research subject.
- To voice concerns about the research.
- To provide input concerning the research process.
- In the event the study staff could not be reached.